

# Word family: \*\*rocket / rockets / rocketed / rocketing\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* rocket

\*\*Plural:\*\* rockets

\*\*Past tense:\*\* rocketed

\*\*Past participle:\*\* rocketed

\*\*Related forms:\*\* rocketing

\*\*Useful expressions / extensions:\*\* space rocket, rocket launch, rocket engine, rocket science, prices rocket, rocket to fame, skyrocket

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* noun ( 名詞 ) / verb ( 動詞 )

Your sentence:

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, drawing imaginary cities, or folding paper \*\*rockets\*\* out of old notebooks.”

## Meaning in this passage

Here, \*\*rocket\*\* means:

> \*\*a model shaped like a rocket, made from folded paper\*\*

The underlying meaning is the familiar vehicle/object designed to travel at very high speed, especially into space. In Leo’s activity, however, it is only a \*\*paper model\*\*, not a real rocket.

\*\*繁體中文： \*\* \*\*火箭；這裡指摺成火箭形狀的紙模型\*\*

\*\*中文翻譯： \*\*

> “He can spend hours ... folding paper rockets out of old notebooks.”

「他可以花幾個小時.....用舊筆記本的紙摺\*\*紙火箭\*\*。」

Here:

\*\*paper rocket = 用紙摺成、外形像火箭的模型\*\*

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# 1. \*\*rocket = vehicle propelled at very high speed ( 火箭 ) — 火箭\*\*

This is the core noun meaning behind your passage.

### Practice 1 — Original

> “He can spend hours ... folding paper \*\*rockets\*\* out of old notebooks.”

「他可以花幾個小時.....用舊筆記本的紙摺\*\*紙火箭\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 2

> “The \*\*rocket\*\* was launched successfully.”

「那枚\*\*火箭\*\*成功發射。」

#### ### Practice 3

> “The \*\*rocket\*\* carried a satellite into space.”

「那枚\*\*火箭\*\*把衛星送上太空。」

**\*\*rocket = 利用高速噴出氣體產生推力、可飛行至高空或太空的飛行器 / 裝置\*\***

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# 2. **\*\*space rocket ( 太空火箭 ) — 運載火箭 ; 太空火箭\*\***

#### ### Practice 4

> “The company is developing a new \*\*space rocket\*\*.”

「公司正在研發一款新的\*\*太空火箭\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 5

> “The \*\*space rocket\*\* carried equipment into orbit.”

「那枚\*\*太空火箭\*\*把設備送入軌道。」

**\*\*space rocket = 用來把人造衛星、設備或載人太空船送往高空 / 太空的火箭\*\***

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# 3. **\*\*rocket = rocket-propelled weapon ( 火箭武器 ) — 火箭彈\*\***

A major military meaning.

#### ### Practice 6

> “The vehicle was struck by a \*\*rocket\*\*.”

「那輛車被一枚\*\*火箭彈\*\*擊中。」

### ### Practice 7

> “Several **rockets** were fired.”

「數枚**火箭彈**被發射出去。」

**rocket** = 以火箭推進方式飛行的武器 / 彈藥

This meaning overlaps physically with the space-vehicle sense, but the **function** is different enough to distinguish in learner use.

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# 4. **rocket** = firework that shoots upward ( 煙花火箭 ) — 火箭煙花 ; 冲天煙花

A useful everyday sense.

### ### Practice 8

> “A **rocket** shot into the night sky.”

「一支**冲天煙花**射上夜空。」

### ### Practice 9

> “They set off several **rockets** at midnight.”

「他們午夜時燃放了幾支**火箭煙花**。」

**rocket** = 點燃後快速升上天空並爆開 / 發光的煙花

This is especially common in British English.

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# 5. **paper/model rocket** ( 模型 ) — 紙火箭 ; 模型火箭

This is the exact physical extension in your sentence.

### ### Practice 10

> “Leo made a **paper rocket**.”

「Leo 摺了一個**紙火箭**。」

### ### Practice 11

> “The children launched a small **model rocket**.”

「孩子們發射了一枚小型**模型火箭**。」

**paper/model rocket** = 模仿真實火箭外形或功能而製作的玩具 / 模型

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# 6. **rocket** — verb = move upward very quickly ( 急速上升 ) — 飛快上升；猛升

A major figurative/intransitive verb sense.

### ### Practice 12

> “Prices **rocketed** after the shortage.”

「短缺出現後，價格**急升**。」

### ### Practice 13

> “The temperature **rocketed** in the afternoon.”

「下午氣溫**急劇上升**。」

**rocket** = 數字、價格、程度等在短時間內非常快速地上升

The image comes directly from a rocket shooting upward.

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# 7. **rocket to + level/amount** ( 飆升至 ) — 急升至；飆升至

### ### Practice 14

> “Sales **rocketed to** record levels.”

「銷售額**急升至**紀錄高位。」

### ### Practice 15

> “The price **rocketed to** \$100.”

「價格**飆升至** 100 元。」

**\*\*rocket to X = 非常快速地上升至某個數值 / 水平\*\***

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# 8. **\*\*rocket by + amount ( 上升了..... ) — 急升；暴升\*\***

### Practice 16

> “Costs **\*\*rocketed by\*\*** 30 percent.”

「成本**\*\*急升了\*\***百分之三十。」

### Practice 17

> “Demand **\*\*rocketed by\*\*** nearly half.”

「需求**\*\*暴升了\*\***接近一半。」

**\*\*rocket by X = 在短時間內增加某個明確幅度\*\***

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# 9. **\*\*rocket = move somewhere extremely quickly ( 飛快移動 ) — 飛奔；猛衝\*\***

The verb can describe literal rapid movement.

### Practice 18

> “The ball **\*\*rocketed\*\*** across the field.”

「球**\*\*飛快地\*\***越過球場。」

### Practice 19

> “He **\*\*rocketed\*\*** down the hill on his bike.”

「他踩單車**\*\*飛快地衝下山坡\*\***。」

**\*\*rocket = 以非常高的速度向某個方向移動\*\***

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# 10. **\*\*rocket to fame/stardom ( 迅速成名 ) — 一炮而紅；迅速走紅\*\***

A common figurative expression.

### ### Practice 20

> “The singer \*\*rocketed to fame\*\* after one hit song.”

「那位歌手憑一首熱門歌曲\*\*迅速走紅\*\*。」

### ### Practice 21

> “The actor \*\*rocketed to stardom\*\* in his twenties.”

「那位演員二十多歲時便\*\*迅速成名\*\*。」

**\*\*rocket to fame/stardom = 在短時間內迅速獲得很高知名度\*\***

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# 11. **\*\*rocket up the rankings/charts ( 排名急升 ) — 排名急升\*\***

### ### Practice 22

> “The song \*\*rocketed up the charts\*\*.”

「那首歌在排行榜上的名次\*\*急升\*\*。」

### ### Practice 23

> “She \*\*rocketed up the rankings\*\* after the tournament.”

「比賽後，她的排名\*\*急速上升\*\*。」

**\*\*rocket up + ranking/chart = 在排名、榜單等中快速向上移動\*\***

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# 12. **\*\*rocket science ( 火箭科學 ) — 火箭科學\*\***

Literal technical sense.

### ### Practice 24

> “He studied \*\*rocket science\*\* at university.”

「他在大學修讀\*\*火箭科學\*\*。」

### ### Practice 25

> “Modern **rocket science** involves physics, engineering, and materials science.”

「現代**火箭科學**涉及物理、工程和材料科學。」

**rocket science** = 研究火箭推進、飛行、設計和相關工程問題的科學 / 技術領域

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# 13. **it's not rocket science** ( 沒那麼難 ) — 不是甚麼高深學問；沒那麼複雜

A very common idiom.

### Practice 26

> “Come on, it's **not rocket science**.”

「拜託，這又**不是甚麼高深學問**。」

### Practice 27

> “Using the machine is **not rocket science**.”

「操作這部機器**沒有那麼複雜**。」

**it's not rocket science** = 某件事情其實不算很難理解或完成

Register:

> informal

The idiom works because rocket science is stereotypically seen as technically difficult.

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# 14. **rocket engine** ( 火箭引擎 ) — 火箭發動機；火箭引擎

### Practice 28

> “The engineers tested the **rocket engine**.”

「工程師測試了**火箭引擎**。」

### Practice 29

> “A **rocket engine** produces thrust by expelling gas.”

「\*\*火箭引擎\*\*透過噴出氣體產生推力。」

**\*\*rocket engine = 利用高速排出氣體產生推力的火箭動力裝置\*\***

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# 15. **\*\*rocket launch ( 火箭發射 ) — 火箭發射\*\***

#### Practice 30

> “Thousands watched the **\*\*rocket launch\*\***.”

「數以千計的人觀看了**\*\*火箭發射\*\***。」

#### Practice 31

> “The **\*\*rocket launch\*\*** was delayed.”

「**\*\*火箭發射\*\***被延遲。」

**\*\*rocket launch = 把火箭從地面發射升空的事件 / 過程\*\***

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# 16. **\*\*rocket launcher ( 火箭發射器 ) — 火箭發射器\*\***

A technical/military compound.

#### Practice 32

> “The vehicle carried a **\*\*rocket launcher\*\***.”

「那輛車裝有**\*\*火箭發射器\*\***。」

#### Practice 33

> “The **\*\*rocket launcher\*\*** was removed from service.”

「該**\*\*火箭發射器\*\***停止服役。」

**\*\*rocket launcher = 用來發射火箭彈的武器 / 裝置\*\***

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# 17. **\*\*rocketing = rising very rapidly ( 急升中的 ) — 急升的 ; 暴漲的\*\***

A participial/adjectival extension.

#### ### Practice 34

> “Consumers are worried about **rocketing prices**.”

「消費者擔心**急升的物價**。」

#### ### Practice 35

> “The city is struggling with **rocketing housing costs**.”

「城市正面對**急劇上升的住屋成本**。」

**rocketing** = 在短時間內快速、大幅上升的

Common with:

- \* prices
- \* costs
- \* demand
- \* rents

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# 18. **skyrocket** = rise extremely rapidly ( 暴升 ) — 飆升；急劇上升

A very useful related lexical extension.

#### ### Practice 36

> “Housing prices **skyrocketed**.”

「樓價**飆升**。」

#### ### Practice 37

> “Demand has **skyrocketed** in recent years.”

「近年需求**急劇上升**。」

**skyrocket** = 在很短時間內大幅、非常快速地上升

This is stronger and more explicitly figurative than ordinary **rise**.

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# 19. \*\*skyrocket — noun = type of firework ( 冲天煙花 ) — 冲天煙花\*\*

The literal source of the verb.

#### ### Practice 38

> “A \*\*skyrocket\*\* exploded above the park.”

「一支\*\*冲天煙花\*\*在公園上空爆開。」

#### ### Practice 39

> “They launched several \*\*skyrockets\*\*.”

「他們燃放了幾支\*\*冲天煙花\*\*。」

**\*\*skyrocket = 點燃後高速升上天空再爆開的煙花\*\***

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**## Important distinction: \*\*rocket vs missile\*\***

#### ### \*\*rocket\*\*

describes propulsion and can refer to:

- \* space vehicles
- \* weapons
- \* fireworks
- \* models

#### ### \*\*missile\*\*

usually means:

> a weapon designed to be launched at a target.

Many missiles may use rocket propulsion, but:

> **\*\*rocket ≠ missile\*\***

A space rocket is not a missile.

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## Important distinction: **rocket vs spacecraft**

### **rocket**

provides propulsion / launches payloads.

### **spacecraft**

is the vehicle designed to operate in space.

A rocket may carry a spacecraft into orbit.

So:

> rocket = propulsion/launch vehicle

> spacecraft = vehicle operating in space

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## Important distinction: **rocket vs satellite**

### **rocket**

carries or propels something upward.

### **satellite**

is an object placed in orbit.

> rocket launches satellite

They are not interchangeable.

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## Important distinction: **rocket vs plane**

### **plane**

generally flies using aerodynamic lift in the atmosphere.

### **rocket**

moves through thrust from expelled gases and does not require atmospheric oxygen in the same way a conventional jet engine does.

For learners, the key distinction is simply:

> plane = aeroplane

> rocket = 火箭

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## Important distinction: **rocket — vehicle vs rocket — weapon**

### Space/launch vehicle:

> “The rocket carried a satellite.”

= 火箭運載衛星。

### Weapon:

> “The rocket hit the target.”

= 火箭彈擊中目標。

Context determines whether Chinese should be:

\* 火箭

\* 火箭彈

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## Important distinction: **rocket — object vs model rocket**

### **rocket**

may refer to a real rocket.

### **model rocket**

= small model, sometimes capable of actual launch.

### **paper rocket**

= paper model shaped like a rocket.

Your passage clearly uses the model/toy sense.

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## Important distinction: **rocket vs rise**

### **rise**

simply means:

> increase/go upward.

### **rocket**

means:

> rise extremely quickly and often dramatically.

> “Prices rose.”

= 價格上升。

> “Prices rocketed.”

= 價格急升 / 暴漲。

So **rocket** adds speed and intensity.

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## Important distinction: **rocket vs soar**

These often overlap figuratively.

### **rocket**

emphasizes:

> sudden, rapid upward movement.

### **soar**

emphasizes:

> rise to a very high level, often smoothly or dramatically.

> prices rocketed

> profits soared

Both can mean 急升, but the imagery differs.

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## Important distinction: **rocket vs skyrocket**

### **rocket**

= rise very quickly.

### **skyrocket**

= rise extremely quickly and dramatically.

**Skyrocket** often sounds even stronger.

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## Important distinction: **rocket to fame vs become famous**

### **become famous**

neutral:

> eventually become well known.

### **rocket to fame**

emphasizes:

> becoming famous extremely quickly.

So the latter encodes speed.

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## Important distinction: **rocket science — literal vs idiomatic**

### Literal:

> “She studies rocket science.”

= 她研究火箭科學。

### Idiomatic:

> “It’s not rocket science.”

= 這不是甚麼很難的事。

The idiom does not actually concern rockets.

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## Important distinction: \*\*rocketing vs rising\*\*

### \*\*rising prices\*\*

= prices going up.

### \*\*rocketing prices\*\*

= prices going up very rapidly.

So \*\*rocketing\*\* is much stronger and more dramatic.

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## Family-extension note

\*\*Rocket\*\* is a good moderate polysemy word.

Its main semantic centres are:

- \* \*\*rocket vehicle\*\*
- \* \*\*rocket-propelled weapon\*\*
- \* \*\*firework rocket\*\*
- \* \*\*model/paper rocket\*\*
- \* \*\*verb: move rapidly upward\*\*
- \* \*\*verb: rise dramatically\*\*
- \* \*\*verb: move very quickly\*\*
- \* \*\*figurative rise in fame/rank\*\*

Useful compounds/extensions include:

- \* \*\*rocket engine\*\*
- \* \*\*rocket launch\*\*
- \* \*\*rocket launcher\*\*
- \* \*\*rocket science\*\*
- \* \*\*not rocket science\*\*
- \* \*\*rocketing\*\*
- \* \*\*skyrocket\*\*

The main figurative branch is highly systematic:

> **literal rocket shoots rapidly upward** → prices, fame, rankings, demand also “rocket” upward

So these should be grouped around one figurative upward-speed concept rather than over-split into separate meanings for prices, fame, and rankings. That follows the manual’s “search broadly, split conservatively” principle.

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## ## Master comparison

| Form / sense                         | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                                | -----                                 |
| <b>rocket</b> — space/launch vehicle | 利用高速噴出氣體產生推力、可飛往高空或太空的飛行器 / 裝置        |
| <b>space rocket</b>                  | 用來把衛星、設備或太空船送往太空的火箭                   |
| <b>rocket</b> — weapon               | 以火箭推進方式飛向目標的武器 / 火箭彈                  |
| <b>rocket</b> — firework             | 點燃後快速升上天空並爆開 / 發光的煙花                  |
| <b>paper/model rocket</b>            | 模仿真實火箭外形或功能而製作的紙製 / 模型物件              |
| <b>rocket</b> — rise quickly         | 數字、價格或程度在短時間內非常快速上升                   |
| <b>rocket to X</b>                   | 急速上升至某個水平 / 數值                        |
| <b>rocket by X</b>                   | 在短時間內增加某個明確幅度                         |
| <b>rocket</b> — move quickly         | 以非常高的速度向某方向移動                         |
| <b>rocket to fame/stardom</b>        | 在短時間內迅速獲得很高知名度                        |
| <b>rocket up rankings/charts</b>     | 在排名 / 榜單中快速向上移動                       |
| <b>rocket science</b>                | 研究火箭推進、飛行和設計的科學 / 工程領域                |
| <b>not rocket science</b>            | 某事並不特別複雜或難理解                          |
| <b>rocket engine</b>                 | 透過高速噴氣產生推力的火箭動力裝置                     |
| <b>rocket launch</b>                 | 火箭由地面發射升空的事件 / 過程                     |
| <b>rocket launcher</b>               | 用來發射火箭彈的裝置 / 武器                       |
| <b>rocketing</b>                     | 在短時間內快速、大幅上升的                         |
| <b>skyrocket</b> — verb              | 非常快速而大幅地飆升                            |
| <b>skyrocket</b> — noun              | 冲天後爆開的煙花                              |

## ### For your original sentence

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, drawing imaginary cities, or folding paper **rockets** out of old notebooks.”

The exact meaning is:

**rocket** = 火箭外形的物件；這裡具體指用紙摺成的火箭模型

Therefore:

> **\*\*paper rockets\*\***

= **\*\*「紙火箭 / 用紙摺成的火箭模型」\*\***

The real-world core image is a vehicle that:

> launches upward

> moves extremely quickly

> travels toward space

Leo is simply recreating that shape imaginatively with paper.

So this is not:

\* **\*\*prices rocketed\*\*** = 價格暴升

\* **\*\*rocket to fame\*\*** = 迅速成名

\* **\*\*rocket weapon\*\*** = 火箭彈

\* **\*\*rocket firework\*\*** = 冲天煙花

It is the **\*\*model-object extension of the literal rocket sense\*\***.